

What is Domestication?



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Domestication is a process by which humans interacted with other species of animals and plants in ways that resulted in genetic changes, leading to heritable physical changes that were passed on to new generations. These changes increased these organisms' value to humans. The genetically and physically transformed lineages of plants and animals that resulted from this process are referred to as domesticates or domesticated species.

Domestication is the process by which plants or animals undergo physical (morphological) and underlying genetic changes as a result of human intervention in their reproduction. This might include deliberate selection, such as choosing only the largest seeds from one generation of plants to grow into the next generation, or choosing only the most docile and friendly animals to breed for the next generation. Unintentional selection can occur, as well, with some traits unexpectedly becoming more common or even fixed (universal) among the domesticated population due to coevolutionary forces.